

# VH Health Data Retention & Storage Policy

## 1. Policy Objective

Ensure secure, cost-effective, and legally compliant storage of all patient-related digital files, including but not limited to:

- Consultation PDFs
- Health Records
- Diagnostic Images (JPEG, PNG)
- Scanned Reports
- Prescriptions

## 2. Retention Durations

| Data Type           | Retention Duration | Storage Tier                                        | Policy Action After Retention |
|---------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Consultation PDFs   | 7 years            | Standard (1y) -> Infrequent (1-2y) -> Glacier (>2y) | Purge after 7 years           |
| Investigation Files | 7 years            | Standard (1y) -> Infrequent (1-2y) -> Glacier (>2y) | Purge after 7 years           |
| Health Records PDFs | 7 years            | Standard (1y) -> Infrequent (1-2y) -> Glacier (>2y) | Purge after 7 years           |
| Prescription Images | 2 years            | Standard (1y) -> Infrequent (1-2y)                  | Purge after 2 years           |
| User Profile Photos | Active use         | Standard                                            | Delete on profile removal     |
| Staff Records       | 7 years post exit  | Standard (1y) -> Infrequent (1-2y) -> Glacier (>2y) | Purge after 7 years post exit |

## 3. Storage Tiers and Transition Plan

- Standard Storage (0-1 year)
  - Fast access for medical staff and patients.
- Infrequent Access (1-2 years)
  - Reduced access, more cost-effective.
- Glacier / Deep Archive (>2 years)

# **VH Health Data Retention & Storage Policy**

- Long-term retention with low cost.

## **4. Purge (After 7 years)**

- Secure deletion of outdated records.

## **4. Access Control**

Access limited to authenticated medical staff and authorized admins. Patients may access their own data via secure channels.

## **5. Cost Control Strategy**

Monthly audits, automated tier transitions, and purge processes to manage storage costs.

## **6. Backup and Disaster Recovery**

Weekly backups with 30-day retention on a separate storage region for disaster recovery.